smarter BALANCED

Answer Key Printout

Total Items: 17

15-March-2026

Item ID	Grade	Subject	Answer Key	Claim	Target	CCSS	DOK	Type
89698	5	ELA	Student receives one point by selecting: • When cement is mixed with water, it becomes very strong. AND • Cement mixed with rocks and gravel can form concrete for use in roads, sidewalks, and buildings.	4	4	5.W.9	2	HTQ
33208	5	ELA	Student receives **one** point for selecting: • E-bikes look like regular bikes, but it may take some practice to get used to riding an e-bike.	4	2	5.W.8	2	HTQ
182986	5	ELA	C	4	2	5.W.8	2	MC
103996	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	2	5.W.8	3	SA
103998	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	3	5.W.9a	4	SA
104002	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	4	5.W.2a	4	WER
32228	5	ELA	C	4	4	5.W.9	2	MC
182994	5	ELA	Student receives one point by selecting: • Studies show that jogging three times a week leads to a stronger heart.	4	4	5.W.9a	2	HTQ
61136	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	4	5.W.9	3	SA
61138	5	ELA	B,F	4	2	5.RI.7	3	MS
54141	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	2	5.RI.9	3	SA
54683	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	2	5.W.3a	4	WER

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182646	5	ELA	People who own businesses have to consider the well-being of all of their guests.: Source #3: New Service Animal Rules Being smart and able to handle small objects makes certain animals more appropriate than other animals to assist people who have a disability.: Source #1: Monkey Helpers, Source #2: Animals Helping People	4	4	5.W.8	3	MI
182648	5	ELA	See appended rubric	4	3	W.5.9	4	SA
182649	5	ELA	See appended rubric	2	7	5.W.1b	4	WER
183047	5	ELA	C,D	4	3	5.W.9	2	MS
3057	5	ELA	Student receives **one** point for selecting: • The birds' black backs and white stomachs help them blend in with the color of the sky and the ocean. AND • Puffins also swim well because they have webbed feet to paddle in the water.	4	2	5.W.8	2	HTQ

PT : Performance Task : If you selected a Performance Task item, all items in that Performance Task are included below even if only one item was selected (e.g., Multiple Choice, Short Answer, Extended Response, etc.). Performance Task items are indicated with "PT" next to the item ID number.

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Appended Rubric :

#103996

Points	Description
2	Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses. KEY ELEMENTS Source #1 (Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation) • Hibernation allows animals to save energy and make it through the winter when food is hard to find. • Bears make dens and stay in them through the winter. • Bears' heart rates slow down from its usual 40 or 50 beats a minute to 10 or 12; their temperature drops a few degrees; they breathe slowly, just as a person in a deep sleep would do. • Bears eat a lot in the fall to get ready for hibernation. Source #3 (A Barn for Bears) • In the fall bears fatten up on acorns and high-fat foods. • Bears find a den in the winter and make a bed of leaves and brush. • A bear's heart rate and body temperature drop. • The bears don't sleep all winter, but remain in their dens for 3 to 5 months if not disturbed. • Female bears have their cubs while they hibernate.

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1	Response is a limited/partial evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two vague or loosely related details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details from either Source #1 or Source #3. Student cites the source for each detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by one detail from either Source #1 or Source #3. Student cites the source for the detail. OR Response is an adequate evidence-based explanation of what the sources say about bears hibernating supported by two details, one from Source #1 and one from Source #3. Student does not cite the source for each detail.
0	Response is an explanation that is insufficient, incorrect or irrelevant.

#103998

Points	Description

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2	Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and an adequate evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works supported by two details from the identified source. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses. KEY ELEMENTS Source #1 (Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation) • Animals save energy by hibernating. • They also avoid needing food or water during a time that food and water is hard to find by hibernating in the winter. • The hypothalamus, a part of the brain, controls hibernation. • The hypothalamus also regulates hunger, thirst, and blood pressure. • Small amounts of blood were taken from hibernating squirrels. This blood was injected into active squirrels in the spring. These squirrels began to hibernate. • Hibernating animals have HIT (hibernation inducement trigger) in their blood. • HIT makes animals prepare to hibernate. • Animals that really hibernate sleep so deeply that it is difficult to wake them. Their body temperature drops significantly, and their heart rate slows as well. • Animals that "in- between" hibernate have a slight drop in body temperature. Their heart rate also slows, but they continue to look for food at times during the winter. • To prepare for hibernation, most animals eat a lot of food. They gain a lot of fat which helps supply them with energy and keeps them warm while they sleep. • Animals that hibernate have a special brown fat across their shoulders and back. This brown fat provides the first burst of energy to the brain, heart, and lungs that signal the animals that hibernation is coming to an end. Source #2 (Do Bears Hibernate?) • Sensors put in five American black bears by scientists from the University of Alaska at Fairbanks showed that bears do hibernate. • The animals were sent to live in fake dens. They settled in for a long sleep. • Their temperature and heart rate dropped. • The rate at which their bodies were burning calories also dropped. Source #3 (A Barn for Bears) • During the fall season, bears eat high-fat foods to fatten up. • They choose a snug den that is dry and protected. • The bear makes a bed of leaves and brush to sleep on. • The heart rate of the bear slows down and its body temperature drops. • The bear does not really sleep all winter, but it usually doesn't leave its den for the next three to five months. • Hibernating keeps each bear in one place for the winter.

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1	Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and a limited or partial evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works, supported by two vague or loosely related details from the identified source. OR Response is an identification of which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works and an adequate evidence-based explanation of why it has the most useful information about how hibernation works, supported by one detail from the identified source.
0	Response is an explanation that is insufficient, incorrect or irrelevant. Just identifying the source is insufficient.

#104002

Points	Description

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4	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has a clear and effective organizational structure, creating a sense of unity and completeness. The organization is sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is consistently and purposefully focused: • controlling/main idea of a topic is clearly communicated, and the focus is strongly maintained for the purpose and audience • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • effective introduction and conclusion • logical progression of ideas from beginning to end; strong connections between and among ideas with some syntactic variety **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides thorough elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes the effective use of source material. The response clearly and effectively develops ideas, using precise language: • comprehensive evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated, relevant, and specific • clear citations or attribution to source material • effective use of a variety of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is clearly appropriate for the audience and purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances content *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an evident organizational structure and a sense of completeness. Though there may be minor flaws, they do not interfere with the overall coherence. The organization is adequately sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is generally focused: • controlling/main idea of a topic is clear, and the focus is mostly maintained for the purpose and audience • adequate use of transitional strategies with some variety to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • adequate introduction and conclusion • adequate progression of ideas from beginning to end; adequate connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides adequate elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes the use of source material. The response adequately develops ideas, employing a mix of precise and more general language: • adequate evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated and relevant, yet may be general • adequate use of citations or attribution to source material • adequate use of some elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is generally appropriate for the audience and purpose • generally appropriate style is evident *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: N/A
2	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an inconsistent organizational structure. Some flaws are evident, and some ideas may be loosely connected. The organization is somewhat sustained between and within paragraphs. The response may have a minor drift in focus:

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	• controlling/main idea of a topic may be somewhat unclear, or the focus may be insufficiently sustained for the purpose and/or audience • inconsistent use of transitional strategies and/or little variety • introduction or conclusion, if present, may be weak • uneven progression of ideas from beginning to end; and/or formulaic; inconsistent or unclear connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides uneven, cursory elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes uneven or limited use of source material. The response develops ideas unevenly, using simplistic language: • some evidence (facts and details) from the source material may be weakly integrated, imprecise, repetitive, vague, and/or copied • weak use of citations or attribution to source material • weak or uneven use of elaborative techniques*; • development may consist primarily of source summary • vocabulary use is uneven or somewhat ineffective for the audience and purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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1	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has little or no discernible organizational structure. The response may be related to the topic but may provide little or no focus: • controlling/main idea may be confusing or ambiguous; response may be too brief or the focus may drift from the purpose and/or audience • few or no transitional strategies are evident • introduction and/or conclusion may be missing • frequent extraneous ideas may be evident; ideas may be randomly ordered or have an unclear progression **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides minimal elaboration of the support/evidence for the controlling/main idea that includes little or no use of source material. The response is vague, lacks clarity, or is confusing: • evidence (facts and details) from the source material is minimal, irrelevant, absent, incorrectly used, or predominantly copied • insufficient use of citations or attribution to source material • minimal, if any, use of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is limited or ineffective for the audience and purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the controlling/main idea **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Evidence/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Evidence/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

#61136

Points	Description

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2	Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by two reasons/examples from different sources. Student identifies the source for each reason/example. Responses may include (but are not limited to): Source #2 (Swimming with the Pod) • Whales use sounds like screeches and whistles to socialize and play. • Whales use the echo of their clicking sounds to tell what is around them. • Whales use calls to stay in touch as they hunt for food. Source #3 (How Humpbacks Go Fishing) • Whales make loud calls to try to chase away other whales. • Whales make trumpet like calls to talk to each other when they work together to hunt fish.
1	Response does not provide an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds but does identify at least one reason/example from a single source that tells why whales use different types of sounds. Student identifies the source. **OR** Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by at least one reason/example from a single source. Student identifies the source. **OR** Response is an evidence-based explanation of why whales use different types of sounds supported by two reasons/examples from different sources. Student does not identify the source for each reason/example. Scoring Note: Score point 1 encompasses partially correct responses.
0	Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, or insufficient.

#54141

Points	Description

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2	Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea and that explains how each example supports the idea. Student cites the source for each example. Responses may include (but are not limited to): Source #2 (Swimming with the Pod) • The mother whale kept the young whale safe. • The mother whale probably helped the baby whale to the surface when he was first born to take his first breath. • The pod may help injured whales come up to the surface for air. • The whales use sounds in the pods to help each other hunt for food. Source #3 (How Humpbacks Go Fishing) • Humpback whales form a circle of bubbles to catch fish. • Some whales chase the fish into the circle of bubbles. • The whales use trumpet like sounds and wave their flippers to talk to each other while catching the fish. • The whales jump up at the same time so they all catch fish together.
1	Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea but doesn't explain how each example supports the idea. Student cites the sources. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from a single source that supports this idea and that explains how that example supports the idea. Student cites the source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides only one piece of evidence from a single source that support this idea and that explains how that example supports the idea. Student cites the source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that provides two pieces of evidence from different sources that support this idea and that explains how each example supports the idea. Student does not cite sources.
0	Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, or insufficient.

#54683

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Points	Description
4	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is fully sustained and the focus is clear and maintained throughout: • an effective plot helps to create a sense of unity and completeness • effectively establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas; strong connection between and among ideas • natural, logical sequence of events from beginning to end • effective opening and closure for audience and purpose *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides thorough, effective elaboration using relevant details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting and/or events are clearly developed • connections to source materials may enhance the narrative • effective use of a variety of narrative techniques that advance the story or illustrate the experience • effective use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that clearly advances the purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances the narration **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is adequately sustained, and the focus is adequate and generally maintained: • an evident plot helps to create a sense of unity and completeness, though there may be minor flaws and some ideas may be loosely connected • adequately establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • adequate use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • adequate sequence of events from beginning to end • adequate opening and closure for audience and purpose *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides adequate elaboration using details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events are adequately developed • connections to source materials may contribute to the narrative • adequate use of a variety of narrative techniques that generally advance the story or illustrate the experience • adequate use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that generally advances the purpose • generally appropriate style is evident **Conventions**: N/A

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2	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, is somewhat sustained and may have an uneven focus: • there may be an inconsistent plot, and/or flaws may be evident • unevenly or minimally establishes a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • uneven use of appropriate transitional strategies and/or little variety • weak or uneven sequence of events • opening and closure, if present, are weak *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides uneven, cursory elaboration using partial and uneven details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events are unevenly developed • connections to source materials may be ineffective, awkward, or vague but do not interfere with the narrative • narrative techniques are uneven and inconsistent • partial or weak use of sensory, concrete, and figurative language that may not advance the purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling
1	**Organization/Purpose**: The organization of the narrative, real or imagined, may be maintained but may provide little or no focus:

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	• there is little or no discernible plot or there may just be a series of events • may be brief or there is little to no attempt to establish a setting, narrator/characters, and/or point of view* • few or no appropriate transitional strategies may be evident and may cause confusion • little or no organization of an event sequence; frequent extraneous ideas and/or a major drift may be evident • opening and/or closure may be missing or unsatisfactory *point of view begins at grade 7 **Development/Elaboration**: The narrative, real or imagined, provides minimal elaboration using few or no details, dialogue, and/or description: • experiences, characters, setting, and/or events may be vague, lack clarity, or confusing • connections to source materials, if evident, may detract from the narrative • use of narrative techniques may be minimal, absent, incorrect, or irrelevant • may have little or no use of sensory, concrete, or figurative language; language does not advance and may interfere with the purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Development/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Development/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

#182648

Points	Description

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2	**Key Elements:** Source #1 (Monkey Helpers) • Every day, for three to five years, capuchin monkeys learn new skills. • Days are spent learning how to load a DVD into a player and pushing play, or opening and closing microwave doors. • The monkeys attending Helping Hands receive years of training. • They are trained only to help with tasks that are done at home. • Years before capuchin monkeys report to their first day of school, they have already spent years around humans. • They live with foster families for up to twelve years. • During this time, they are taught how to share a house with humans. They get used to being around pets. They even learn basic tasks like how to take baths. • Capuchin monkeys are coached and trained for up to five years at Helping Hands. • They pick up tools and use them to solve problems. **Rubric:** (2 points) Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes two details from that source that support this evaluation and that explain why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source.

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1	(1 point) Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes one detail from that source that supports this evaluation and that explains why the detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that correctly identifies the most helpful source AND includes two details from that source that support this evaluation but does not explain why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source. OR Response is an evidence-based explanation that does not identify a source or correctly identify the most helpful source but includes two details from the correct source and that explains why each detail supports the idea that it is the most helpful source.
0	(0 points) Response is an explanation that is incorrect, irrelevant, insufficient, or blank.

#182649

Points	Description

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4	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has a clear and effective organizational structure, creating a sense of unity and completeness. The organization is sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is consistently and purposefully focused: • opinion is introduced, clearly communicated, and the focus is strongly maintained for the purpose and audience • consistent use of a variety of transitional strategies to clarify the relationships between and among ideas • effective introduction and conclusion • logical progression of ideas from beginning to end; strong connections between and among ideas with some syntactic variety **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides thorough and convincing elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes the effective use of source material. The response clearly and effectively develops ideas, using precise language: • comprehensive evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated, relevant, and specific • clear citations or attribution of source material • effective use of a variety of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is clearly appropriate for the audience and purpose • effective, appropriate style enhances content *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: N/A

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3	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an evident organizational structure and a sense of completeness. Though there may be minor flaws, they do not interfere with the overall coherence. The organization is adequately sustained between and within paragraphs. The response is generally focused: • opinion is clear, and the focus is mostly maintained for the purpose and audience • adequate use of transitional strategies with some variety to clarify relationships between and among ideas • adequate introduction and conclusion • adequate progression of ideas from beginning to end; adequate connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides adequate elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes the use of source material. The response adequately develops ideas, employing a mix of precise with more general language: • adequate evidence (facts and details) from the source material is integrated and relevant, yet may be general • adequate use of citations or attribution to source material • adequate use of some elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is generally appropriate for the audience and purpose • generally appropriate style is evident *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: N/A
2	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has an inconsistent organizational structure. Some flaws are evident, and some ideas may be loosely connected. The organization is somewhat sustained between and within paragraphs. The response may have a minor drift in focus:

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	• opinion may be somewhat unclear, or the focus may be insufficiently sustained for the purpose and/or audience • inconsistent use of transitional strategies and/or little variety • introduction or conclusion, if present, may be weak • uneven progression of ideas from beginning to end; and/or formulaic; inconsistent or unclear connections between and among ideas **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides uneven, cursory elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes partial or uneven use of source material. The response develops ideas unevenly, using simplistic language: • some evidence (facts and details) from the source material may be weakly integrated, imprecise, repetitive, vague, and/or copied • weak use of citations or attribution to source material • weak or uneven use of elaborative techniques*; development may consist primarily of source summary • vocabulary use is uneven or somewhat ineffective for the audience and purpose • inconsistent or weak attempt to create appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: The response demonstrates an adequate command of conventions: • adequate use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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1	**Organization/Purpose**: The response has little or no discernible organizational structure. The response may be related to the opinion but may provide little or no focus: • opinion may be confusing or ambiguous; response may be too brief or the focus may drift from the purpose and/or audience • few or no transitional strategies are evident • introduction and/or conclusion may be missing • frequent extraneous ideas may be evident; ideas may be randomly ordered or have an unclear progression **Evidence/Elaboration**: The response provides minimal elaboration of the support/evidence for the opinion and supporting idea(s) that includes little or no use of source material. The response is vague, lacks clarity, or is confusing: • evidence (facts and details) from the source material is minimal, irrelevant, absent, incorrectly used, or predominantly copied • insufficient use of citations or attribution to source material • minimal, if any, use of elaborative techniques* • vocabulary is limited or ineffective for the audience and purpose • little or no evidence of appropriate style *Elaborative techniques may include the use of personal experiences that support the opinion. **Conventions**: The response demonstrates a partial command of conventions: • limited use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling

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0	**Organization/Purpose**: N/A **Evidence/Elaboration**: N/A **Conventions**: The response demonstrates little or no command of conventions: • infrequent use of correct sentence formation, punctuation, capitalization, grammar usage, and spelling **NS (No Score)** **Organization/Purpose**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose **Evidence/Elaboration**: • Insufficient (includes copied text) • In a language other than English • Off-topic • Off-purpose

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#1 - 89698

A student is writing a report about cement. The student wrote the following opinion: "Cement is one of the most helpful things for making surfaces that can bear a lot of weight." She found a source. Read the source. Click on **two** sentences that have information to support the opinion.

Source

Cement is a mixture of materials. When limestone is mixed with clay, it forms the substance of cement. Cement is made when these materials are heated and allowed to harden. When cement is mixed with water, it becomes very strong. Very often, cement is made into blocks using patterns called forms. It can also be dyed various colors. Cement mixed with rocks and gravel can form concrete for use in roads, sidewalks, and buildings.

#2 - 33208

A student is writing a research report about electric bicycles. Read Source 1 and the directions that follow.

Source 1

An electric bike is, for the most part, like a regular bicycle. The rider sits on a seat and puts her feet on the pedals. She steers using the handlebars. The only difference is that an electric bike has a motor. The motor makes riding the bicycle easier. This is because the motor gives the bike power. The motor does not replace the pedaling that the rider has to do. It just adds power to the rider's own efforts. The bike also has a controller. This lets the rider choose if and when to start and use the motor.

The student found another source. Read Source 2. Click on **one** sentence that has information with a different point of view from the information in Source 1.

Source 2

Electric bikes, or e-bikes, have a battery and motor. The battery must be charged for the motor to work. E-bikes look like regular bikes, but it may take some practice to get used to riding an e-bike. Each time the rider pushes the pedal, the bike gets a rush of energy that makes it jolt forward. These bursts make the ride less smooth than a regular bike.

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#3 - 182986

A student made a plan for a research report. Read the plan and the directions that follow.

Research Report Plan

Topic: seahorses
Audience: fifth-grade students
Purpose: to inform
Research Question: Why is the seahorse population decreasing?

The student found information for the research report. Which piece of information should the student use in her report?

A. Seahorses are small and able to hide easily.

B. Adult seahorses do not move around much.

C. Wild seahorses are captured and sold all around the world.

D. Seahorses like to live among the seagrass in warm ocean waters.

#4 - 103996 , #5 - 103998 , #6 - 104002 [PT]

Student Directions

Ready for a Nap Informational Performance Task

Task:
Your school is preparing for an assembly to celebrate Earth Day. As part of the assembly, each class is responsible for setting up an exhibit about different aspects of nature. Your class has been assigned the theme "Unusual Animal Behaviors." As part of the project, you have decided to learn more about hibernation. You decide to do some research, and you find three sources about hibernation.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly skim the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the Global Notes button to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. You may also use scratch paper to take notes.

In Part 2, you will write an informational article using information you have read.

Directions for Beginning:
You will now review several sources. You can review any of the sources as often as you like.

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Research Questions:
After reviewing the sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have read and viewed, which should help you write your informational article.

You may click on the Global Notes button or refer back to your scratch paper to review your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below the items.

Both the Global Notes on the computer and your written notes on scratch paper will be available to you in Part 1 and Part 2 of the performance task.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

Source #1
This article from *Cricket* magazine explains how animal hibernation works.

Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation
by Margery Facklam

A 300-pound grizzly bear shuffled through a dry autumn meadow in Yellowstone National Park. She stopped to catch a mouse with one swat of her huge paw and then ambled on toward a clear stream. At the water's edge, she stood on her hind legs to sniff the air before she plunged into the cold water. In a moment she caught a salmon with a swoop of her paw and gulped it down. She devoured two more fish before she waded out and shook the water from her thick, gray-tipped, "grizzled" fur.

Day after day the grizzly loped through the meadows in search of insects, berries, and small rodents. . . . Food seemed to be the only thing on her mind.

But as she grew fatter and the air grew colder, she began to search for something else—her winter den. When she found a place that suited her, on a steep north-facing slope at the base of a large fir tree, she started to dig. It was a tight fit as she tunneled under the tree roots that would make a strong roof for her den, but she needed room enough only to squeeze through to her bedroom. In the spring, after four or five months of a deep sleep called hibernation, she would be much thinner.

Late in November, when the temperature had dropped below freezing, the big grizzly no longer raced across the open meadow. Day after day she acted as though she were walking in her sleep. Then one day, when the wind whipped the snow in swirls around her, the bear crawled into her den.

All night it snowed, covering the opening to her tunnel. No one would be able to find it. The grizzly was safe for the winter, cozy and warm beneath the blanket of snow. She would not eat [or] drink water, . . . until spring. Her heart rate would slow down from its usual 40 or 50 beats a minute to 10 or 12. Her temperature would drop a few degrees, and she would breathe slowly, just as a person in a deep sleep would do.

How does hibernation work? How can animals go without food and water for many months without starving to death? What tells them it's time to enter the den? And then how do they know it's time to wake up? . . .

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Hibernation is a way for animals to save energy and survive through the winter when food is hard to find. (Hiberna is a Latin word that means winter.) It is controlled by a part of the brain called the hypothalamus (hi-po-thal-a-mus), which also regulates hunger, thirst, and blood pressure.

In one experiment to find out how hibernation works, a biologist [scientist] took a small amount of blood from hibernating ground squirrels. He froze the blood. In spring, he defrosted it and injected it into a different group of ground squirrels who had been running around. Not long after, the energetic ground squirrels curled up and began to hibernate.

Scientists have found in the blood of hibernating animals a substance they call HIT, which stands for hibernation inducement[1] trigger. Although they do not know exactly what this . . . is, they have learned that this trigger goes into action when one of three things happens: when the days become shorter and there is less light, when there are big changes in temperature (either extreme cold or heat), or when food is scarce.

There are different levels of hibernation. The animals known as the "real" hibernators, such as woodchucks and ground squirrels, sleep so deeply that they are almost impossible to wake up. . . . During hibernation, the woodchuck's heart slows from beating 80 times a minute to only 4 or 5. Its normal body temperature of 100 degrees Fahrenheit drops to 45 or 50 degrees. But even so, every few weeks the woodchuck gets up to nibble on food and use the small toilet room in its underground burrow. . . .

The in-between hibernators really take only long winter naps. Skunks, raccoons, and a few others lower their body temperature a couple of degrees and breathe more slowly, but they wake up to forage [search] for food between winter storms.

In order to survive weeks or months without food, most hibernating animals go on an eating binge in late summer and early fall. The fat they build up supplies energy and keeps them warm while they sleep. But along with this regular white fat, hibernating mammals have patches of special brown fat across their shoulders and back. The brown fat works like a fast food restaurant; it delivers quick energy whenever it is needed.

A hibernating animal must warm up before it can wake up, and its brain has to warm up first in order to send messages to the rest of the body to get moving. In its handy location across the shoulders and back, the brown fat is close to the hibernating mammal's brain, heart, and lungs, which must get the first spurt of energy as hibernation comes to an end.

Whether a groundhog sound asleep in its burrow or a grizzly wintering in a cozy den—each hibernating animal follows the built-in pattern of its species to survive the cycle of the seasons. Hibernation is an amazing way for some animals to protect themselves until food and warmth reappear in spring.

[1]inducement: something that gives you a reason for doing something

Do Not Disturb: The Mysteries of Animal Hibernation by Margery Facklam. Copyright © 1990 by Carus Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company.

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Source #2
This article from *Time for Kids* magazine provides information about a study that answers the question: Do bears hibernate?

Do Bears Hibernate?

We think that bears hibernate. They disappear into dens for months at a time and come out in the spring looking skinny. But hibernation is difficult to study, because bears that live in zoos do not follow their natural sleeping and eating cycles.

Now, a report in the journal *Science* suggests that bears do truly hibernate. Scientists from the University of Alaska at Fairbanks worked with five American black bears. Sensors were put inside the bears. The animals were then sent to live in fake dens. . . . In November, the bears settled in for a long sleep. Scientists watched them on video cameras and monitored their vital signs.[1] The bears almost always slept in a curled position. They moved around once or twice a day. Their body temperature dropped, as did the rate at which their bodies burned calories.

The findings could help scientists learn how to create healthy hibernation in humans. This could someday be used for long-distance space travel, when a long-lasting, deep sleep would help during the journey.

[1]vital signs: important things a body does that can be measured to check health—such as breathing and heart rate

Do Bears Hibernate? Copyright © 2011 by Time Inc. Reprinted by permission of Time Inc.

Source #3
This article from *Highlights for Children* magazine talks about a scientist that studies hibernating bears.

A Barn for Bears
by Andy Boyles

Dr. Michael Vaughan has a barn for bears. On a wooded mountain near Blacksburg, Virginia, the low barn sits under the trees.

In November the air inside is cold, which is just right for bears. . . .

They are preparing to enter the remarkable sleeplike state called hibernation.

Dr. Vaughan and his students study the bears before, during, and after hibernation. In the spring, they release the bears.

This research has been going on for more than ten years, ever since Dr. Vaughan began working at Virginia Tech University. "The chance to work with these big animals was just too good to pass up," he says.

Winter "Sleep"
. . . In the fall, a bear fattens up on acorns and other high-fat foods. As winter sets in, the bear usually chooses a snug den, such as a dry space under a big rock.

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The bear curls up on a bed it has made of leaves and brush. Its heart slows down, and its body temperature drops. The bear does not really sleep all winter. But as long as the bear is not disturbed, it does not leave its den for the next three to five months—not to eat, not even to eliminate wastes from its body.

Female bears always have their cubs, usually two or three of them, in the middle of winter. The mother curls around her sightless, helpless young to keep them warm and to nurse them. (When the cubs are born, they weigh about half a pound. By spring, they are big enough to leave the den with their mother.)

Because hibernation keeps each bear in one place, winter is a good time for scientists to find and study bears. But if researchers disturb a hibernating bear too often, it may leave and spend valuable energy searching for another den.

That's one reason Dr. Vaughan keeps bears in a barn. Researchers can study each of them once every ten days. . . .

A Barn for Bears by Andy Boyles. Copyright © 1999 by Highlights for Children. Reprinted by permission of Highlights for Children.

#4 - 103996

Source #1 and Source #3 discuss bears hibernating. Explain what the sources say about bears hibernating. Use **two** details, one detail from Source #1 and one detail from Source #3, to support your explanation. For each detail, include the source title or number.

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#5 - 103998

Which source has the most useful information about how hibernation works? Explain why this source has the most useful information about how hibernation works. Give at least **two** details from the source to support your answer.

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Student Directions

Ready for a Nap Informational Performance Task

Part 2

You will now review your notes and sources, and plan, draft, revise, and edit your writing. You may use your notes and go back to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your writing will be scored; then begin your work.

Your Assignment:
Your class has been learning about unusual animal behaviors in preparation for your school's Earth Day assembly. As part of your class's exhibit, you will write an informational article about hibernation. Your article will be read by other students, teachers, and parents who attend the Earth Day assembly.

Using more than one source, develop a main idea about hibernation. Choose the most important information from more than one source to support your main idea. Then, write an informational article that is several paragraphs long. Clearly organize your article and support your main idea with details from the sources. Use your own words except when quoting directly from the sources. Be sure to give the source title or number when using details from the sources.

REMEMBER: A well-written informational article

• has a clear main idea.
• is well-organized and stays on the topic.
• has an introduction and a conclusion.
• uses transitions.
• uses details from the sources to support your main idea.
• puts the information from the sources in your own words, except when using direct quotations from the sources.
• gives the title or number of the source for the details or facts you included.
• develops ideas clearly.
• uses clear language.
• follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar usage).

Now begin work on your informational article. Manage your time carefully so that you can

1. plan your informational article.
2. write your informational article.
3. revise and edit the final draft of your informational article.

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write an informational article that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

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Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your informational article.

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#7 - 32228

A student is writing a research report about vegetables. She wrote an opinion in the report. Read the opinion and the directions that follow.

Healthy Choices

Food choices affect a person's health. Through digestion, the human body breaks down foods so that they become fuel for the body. Eating vegetables provides the right kind of fuel, so it is important to eat vegetables if you want to be healthy.

The student took notes about vegetables. Which note supports the student's opinion?

A. Research has helped farmers grow larger vegetables.

B. Boiling vegetables can cause them to lose vitamins and flavor.

C. Experts recommend filling half your plate with vegetables at each meal.

D. People were more likely to grow vegetables in their own gardens in the past.

#8 - 182994

A student is writing a report about exercise. The student wrote the following opinion.

Regular exercise is a good way to stay healthy.

She found a source. Read the source. Click on the sentence that has information to support the opinion. Click on **one** sentence.

Source 1: Healthy Habits

The best way to stay healthy is to have healthy habits. Everybody needs to eat, sleep, and exercise. Finding a way to make these part of your everyday life may take some hard work. But once they are habits, it won't seem like work.

A diet filled with fresh fruits and vegetables is better than one filled with cookies. Grab an orange from the refrigerator instead of reaching for those cookies. Another good habit to follow is sleeping enough. Most people should try to get at least 8 hours of sleep each night. Another healthy habit is exercise. Studies show that jogging three times a week leads to a stronger heart. Like the other healthy habits above, it may take time to plan an exercise program. But once exercise becomes a habit, it is easy to do.

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Student Directions

Whales Narrative Performance Task

Task:

Your class has been learning about oceans around the world. You and your classmates are most interested in the animals that live in these oceans. Your teacher has asked each of you to pick an ocean animal to research, and you have picked whales. While doing your research, you found a book and two magazine articles about whales.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly skim the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the NOTES box to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. Your notes will be available to you as you answer the questions.

In Part 2, you will write a story about a topic related to the sources.

Directions for Beginning:
You will now look at three sources. You can go back to any of the sources as often as you like.

Research Questions:
After examining the sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer the question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have reviewed, which should help you write your story.

You may click on the NOTES button above the sources to look at your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below them.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

Source #1
Here is an article about whales.

Whales

by Tamra Orr

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King of the Sea
Deep under the surface of the ocean, a gentle giant swims through the water. Larger than many of the dinosaurs, the whale is the true king of the sea. Some species grow as long as 100 feet long. They can weigh more than 100 tons! Although there are many different types of whales, and they come in various sizes and colors, their bodies are all quite similar. They use flippers and tails to help push themselves through the water and keep their balance.

On the Surface and Below
Although many people think of whales as fish, they are actually warm-blooded mammals. They need air to breathe, so they have to rise to the surface of water to take a deep breath. Instead of using a nose or mouth, however, whales use a blowhole on the top of their heads. They take in air through the hole and straight into their lungs. They exhale the same way. Once whales take a few breaths, they dive back down, sometimes thousands of feet deep. Many of them can stay underwater for more than an hour before having to come back up and breathe again.

When it comes time to sleep, whales rest near the surface, so they can come to the top and breathe whenever needed. In order to do this, whales do something rather amazing. They only allow one side of their brain to sleep at a time! This way, they are aware of when they need to take another breath!

Whales come to the surface to do more than breathe, however. As big and heavy as they are, many of them jump out of the water. This action is known as breaching. Why do they do it? Even the experts are not sure, but they have a number of theories. Many scientists think the mammals do it to shake the barnacles* and other growths off of their skin. Other ideas are that breaching is done to scare away predators or simply because it is a lot of fun!

The Search for Food
Whales live in deep ocean waters across the world. When summer arrives and the water begins to warm up, some species migrate, or move to colder waters in search of more food. How do they keep warm? Whales have built-in coats known as blubber under their skin. Blubber is a thick layer of fat and it not only keeps the mammals warm, but helps them float and gives them extra energy when it is hard to find enough to eat. In the winter, whales migrate to warmer water to have their young.

Whales are incredible creatures that live under the water, but come above it to breathe the air, jump, and play. They truly are the kings of the sea.

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*barnacles: small crustaceans that attach themselves to other animals or objects

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Whale breach, 2013. Courtesy of National Oceanic and Atmospheric Association.

Source #2
This article from *Click* magazine is about what life is like for whales living in the ocean.

Swimming with the Pod

by Catherine Ripley

PFFFFF! Splash! A six-year-old male orca whale surfaces, shooting a big spray of stale air from the blowhole on top of his head. For several minutes he and his family slice slowly through the ocean waves, breathing deeply, filling their large lungs with air. Then, side by side, the orcas dive.

The male is the youngest and swims close to his mom. To their left is his uncle and in front, leading them all, is his grandmother. A second uncle swims nearby. And just beyond him are two more families in the pod, which is the name for a group of whales. The 16 whales in this pod live together in Johnstone Strait, on the northwest coast of Canada.

Most orcas stay with the pod they are born into for their whole lives. As an infant, the young male swam beneath his mother's belly, where he was safe and could nurse easily. When he was born, his mother probably helped him to the surface to take his first breath. Whales need air, just like people, or they will drown. Sometimes the pod might even help an injured whale come up to the surface for air.

When orcas are not searching for food, they like to "talk" and socialize—even play! They roll and splash in the salty water, and they call to each other. Scr-eee-CH! Whistle! Whistle!

The young male spy hops. He punches his head and upper body above the water and looks around. He sees a female cousin breach the waves. She throws her body almost completely out of the water and crashes down again. KERSPLASH! Another cousin swims sideways and smacks her flipper playfully against the water. SLAP!

Now Grandmother is speeding toward shore and the family follows. She rubs

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her massive body through the smooth rounded rocks on the bottom of the bay. Mom goes next and the young male follows. The family spends the next hour "beach rubbing." Scientists think this feels good to orcas and may help keep their skin clean.

But most of the pod's day is spent finding food. The whales spread out and send out a series of fast clicks as they swim down the bay together. Click, click, click! The orcas can tell from the way their clicks echo through the water if a school of salmon is nearby!

Some orcas hunt seals, sea lions, and porpoises, instead of fish. They live in small groups and are silent when they hunt. No chatting allowed! Their prey might be listening!

But the young male's pod eats mainly salmon. The whales use many calls to stay in touch as they hunt. "Wee-oo-uuo," cries a cousin from across the bay. "Wee-oo-uuo," answers Grandmother. "Squ-eee-AL, CRe-e-e-eak," calls Mom. Each pod "speaks" slightly differently from the next, and scientists can recognize a particular pod by the sounds its whales make.

Soon the orcas' bellies are tight with salmon. It is time for a rest. Orcas cannot sleep under the water. They must come to the surface every few minutes to breathe. So they cruise slowly forward, diving, then surfacing for air, in a regular resting pattern that can last for hours. Swimming together, the young whale and his family surface, breathe, and dive ... surface, breathe, and dive... ZZZZZZ!

"Swimming with the Pod" by Catherine Ripley, from *Click*. Copyright © 2007 by Epals Media. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company.

Source #3

This article from *Highlights for Children* magazine is about ways that whales get food in the ocean.

How Humpbacks Go Fishing

by Linda Brown Anderson

Humpback whales are known for feeding alone or in pairs. Most of the time, they plow through the ocean with their huge mouths open, scooping up thousands of tiny shrimp-like creatures called krill.

But humpbacks that live near the west coast of North America have a surprising and spectacular way of catching fish. When they spot a school of herring, the humpbacks dive into the depths and close in on the fish from below. A steady flow of bubbles rises to the surface, forming a circle.

Suddenly, all of the whales explode out of the water at once, right in the middle of the bubble-circle. Their huge mouths are open and full of silver, wriggling fish.

Scientists wanted to know more about how the whales fed on schools of fish. Using underwater microphones, they listened to humpbacks as they fed. The whales made magnificent trumpet-like sounds as they swept up and ate the fish.

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The researchers also used the Critter cam, a video camera that can be attached harmlessly to the back of a whale. It showed that the whales waved their huge flippers back and forth as they fed.

Most researchers thought the humpbacks were fighting over the fish. Whales are known to use bubbles and loud calls when they try to chase away other whales. Maybe they also waved their flippers to shoo one another away.

Humpback whales blowing bubbles

A Deep Mystery

Dr. Fred Sharpe had a radical idea for the late 1980s, when he began his research. Maybe the whales were working together!

Dr. Sharpe led a team of researchers. They used sonar to "see" deeper into the water. A sonar device sends out sound waves, then catches the echoes of those waves after they bounce off objects, such as whales, fish, and bubbles. Using the echoes, the sonar creates pictures of the objects.

The sonar showed that, to a humpback, bubbles are tools. A single whale swims below the fish, carefully releasing air from its blowhole to create a wall of bubbles.

Also using sonar, the scientists saw other whales moving toward the herring, chasing the fish toward the bubble wall. The herring were reluctant to try to escape through the bubbles. The bubble-blowing whale began to swim in a circle, making the wall of bubbles go all the way around the fish. The fish were trapped in a bubble net!

Using an underwater microphone, the research team recorded the sounds of the whales. The whales swam under the herring and began their trumpet-like calls. Then the whales swam upward all at once, waving their flippers, and gulped a large number of fish.

The whales were working together!

"How Humpbacks Go Fishing" by Linda Brown Anderson, from *Highlights for Children*. Text copyright © 2011 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of Highlights for Children, Inc. Photograph copyright © 2011 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of Highlights for Children, Inc.

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#9 - 61136

Explain why whales use different types of sounds. Give **two** reasons, using information from two different sources. Be sure to give the title or number of the sources you use.

#10 - 61138

All three sources describe how whales behave. Choose **two** details below that can be found in more than one of the sources.

A. Whales migrate in summer and winter.

B. Whales breathe air through a blowhole.

C. Whales do beach rubbing to clean their skin.

D. Whales stay with their pods their whole lives.

E. Whales move to warm water to have their young.

F. Whales rest on or near the surface of the water.

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#11 - 54141

Explain how whales work together to help each other. Give **one** detail from Source #2 and **one** detail from Source #3 to support your explanation. For each detail, identify the source title or number.

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Student Directions for Part 2

You will now review your notes and sources, plan, draft, revise, and edit your story. You may use your notes and refer to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your story will be scored; then begin your work.

Your assignment:

Your class is making a storybook about adventures in the ocean to finish your Oceans Around the World unit. You will write a story to contribute to the class storybook. You have decided to write a story about a family that goes on vacation to a place right by the ocean. They go out on a boat ride and spot a huge creature coming out of the water. It's a whale! Tell the story of what happens when the family sees the whale.

Your story will be read by your teacher and the other students in your class. When writing your story, find ways to use information and details from the sources to improve your story. Make sure you develop your character(s), the setting, and the plot, using details, dialogue, and description.

REMEMBER: A well-written story:

- has a clear plot and clear sequence of events
- is well-organized and has a point of view
- uses details from the sources to support your story
- uses clear language
- follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar)

Now begin work on your story. Manage your time carefully so that you can:

1.
plan your story

2.
write your story

3.
revise and edit the final draft of your story

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write a story that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

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Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your story.

#13 - 182646 , #14 - 182648 , #15 - 182649 [PT]

Student Directions

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Service Animals Opinion Performance Task

Task:
A person with a disability visited your class today to discuss how his trained service animal allows him to enjoy more independence and participate more fully in everyday activities. You and your classmates became interested in learning more about service animals. Your teacher took your class to the school library to look up more information about this topic. You have found three articles about service animals.

After you have reviewed these sources, you will answer some questions about them. Briefly scan the sources and the questions that follow. Then, go back and read the sources carefully so you will have the information you will need to answer the questions and complete your research. You may click on the Global Notes button to take notes on the information you find in the sources as you read. You may also use scratch paper to take notes.

In Part 2, you will write an opinion paper using information you have read.

Directions for Beginning:

You will now review several sources. You can review any of the sources as often as you like.

Research Questions:

After reviewing the research sources, use the rest of the time in Part 1 to answer question(s) about them. Your answers to these questions will be scored. Also, your answers will help you think about the information you have read and viewed, which should help you write your opinion paper.

You may click on the Global Notes button or refer back to your scratch paper to look at your notes when you think it would be helpful. Answer the questions in the spaces below the items.

Both the Global Notes on the computer and your written notes on scratch paper will be available to you in Part 1 and Part 2 of the performance task.

Part 1

Sources for Performance Task:

Source #1
You have found a current article about capuchin monkeys on a website about service animals. The author is a veterinarian who writes articles for educational publications.

Monkey Helpers

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by Tamra Orr

An Unusual Set of Helping Hands

Every day people make countless moves that they tend to take for granted. They scratch their noses and pull on their backpacks. People grab something to eat and push up their glasses. They flip the pages of their textbooks and turn off their lights. For people living with injuries to the spinal cord, however, these basic movements are very difficult. For some, they are even impossible. For the past 35 years, more than 160 people with injuries to the spinal cord have found support from a very unusual set of helping hands: those of specially trained capuchin monkeys.

Capuchin monkeys are very small. Some weigh less than eight pounds, even when fully grown. They are also extremely smart. In the wild, they have shown the ability to pick up tools and use them to solve problems. Their hands can easily carry small tools. This makes it easier for them to handle modern items such as remotes and cell phones.

Although capuchin monkeys are smart and are able to handle small tools, not all types of monkeys are ideal to use as service animals. Some monkeys, such as howler monkeys, are too large or strong. Monkeys who have not been properly trained are also unreliable. They might behave in ways that are hard to predict. For example, a monkey could suddenly hurt a person if it got angry or frightened for some reason.

While some people believe capuchin monkeys are wonderful service animals, not everyone agrees. Capuchins are small, easy to train, and able to bond, or form close relationships, with humans. However, they are still, in the end, wild animals. April Truitt, director of the Primate Rescue Center in Kentucky, says that having a wild animal in your home may put both the animal and the owner at increased risk of getting injured. She points out that it is possible for capuchins to become violent suddenly and this can be a danger to their owners and others.

Long Before School Starts

Long before capuchin monkeys begin their training, they have already spent years around humans. Born in a Massachusetts zoo, they must live with foster families as long as twelve years before beginning their training on how to assist a person with a disability. During this time, they are taught how to share a house with humans. They get used to being around pets. They even learn basic tasks like how to take baths. This requires a great deal of time and effort.

Learning to Help

Capuchin monkeys learn how to assist people with disabilities at Helping Hands, otherwise known as the monkey college, in Boston, Massachusetts. This college is not quite like going to a traditional school. Every day, for three to five years, capuchin monkeys learn new skills. Their lessons do not focus on reading and writing though. Days are spent learning how to load a DVD into a player and push play, or how to open and close microwave doors. This education takes time, patience, and money. The cost of educating just one monkey is close to

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$40,000. Finally, after up to five years of training, the animals finish school. Now the monkeys are ready to go and live with someone who needs them to help make life a little bit easier.

The Simple Things

Having a capuchin monkey in the house is not the same as having a dog or cat. Because of their training and their intelligence, these monkeys are able to do an amazing number of chores for the person who is disabled and cannot do them alone. Along with operating microwaves and DVD players, these service animals can also turn lights off and on for their new owners. They can open bottles and flip the pages of a book for their owner. They can even reach out and scratch an annoying itch.

Every year, Helping Hands places dozens of monkeys in homes of people with disabilities. The monkeys take good care of their owners. In return, the owners feel safer and more able to do tasks that so many others take for granted.

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Helping Hands. (n.d.). Training center. Retrieved from: http://www.monkeyhelpers.org

Source #2
You found an article about service animals in a 2002 issue of *Click*, a magazine for children.

Animals Helping People

A monkey who helps you drink out of a straw? A dog that opens the refrigerator door when you want a snack? A pony gentle enough to ride even if you cannot see? When people need extra care, special animals are there to help!

Seeing Eye dogs are trained to be the eyes for people who cannot see. All over the world, Seeing Eye dogs are hard at work—guiding, protecting, and loving their blind masters.

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Horseback riding is good exercise. It also helps people feel happy and confident. Even riders who cannot see, or who have trouble moving their muscles, can have fun on a quiet, gentle, well-trained horse.

Hearing dogs help people who are deaf or hard-of-hearing. These smart, friendly, energetic dogs are specially trained to let their owners know when the doorbell rings, the smoke alarm goes off, or the baby wakes up from a nap.

This boy needs both his hands and all his energy just to walk. Luckily, his assistance dog is there to carry his backpack. Assistance dogs are good helpers —and good friends!

An assistance dog is trained to help

. . . Assistance animals like this capuchin monkey are smart and nimble enough to help in lots of ways—they can turn the lights on and off, play a CD, or get their owners a cool drink!

A capuchin monkey helps with many tasks

This girl is part of a special program to help children with serious physical and learning difficulties. Swimming with dolphins helps the children relax—and who wouldn't love being around such wild and beautiful creatures!

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Dolphins are calming creatures

Animals helping people. *Click*, *5*(9), 21-23.

Source #3
This article from a magazine about animal rights describes new service animal rules that are included as part of a federal law. The author is on staff at the magazine and has a legal background.

New Service Animal Rules
by Clare Mishica

New rules regarding service animals were added to the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) in March 2011. The ADA is a law that protects the rights of people with disabilities.

The new rules limit the kind of service animals that people with disabilities can have in public places. Now, only dogs and miniature horses are allowed in public places. The changes were meant to clear up confusion regarding service animals in public places. Business owners were unclear about the kind of service animals that were allowed in their businesses. They were also unclear about the amount of responsibility that they had for service animals that were brought into their businesses.

A man has a large snake draped over his shoulders. He wants to enter a café for lunch and says the snake is a service animal that helps and comforts him. In the past, the law would have required the café to allow the man to bring his snake inside. This was because people were allowed to choose any service animal as helpers, including pigs, birds, and lizards! Before the new rule, any type of animal could have been considered a service animal. As long as the owner felt that the animal provided him/her assistance, then any type of animal could be used as a service animal. Once the new rules went into effect, the only service animals permitted in public places are dogs and miniature horses.

What Made the Changes Necessary?
The changes were needed to protect people from diseases. Different animals carry certain diseases. When animals go into public places, they might pass illnesses to humans. In addition, some animals are not trained to keep an area clean. For example, birds could leave droppings on a store floor. This creates an unhealthy setting for others.

Second, the law was changed to help business owners. In the past, businesses such as hotels had to accept all types of service animals, and that could create problems. For example, some animals are large or noisy. Others might cause

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damage or have special needs. Dogs and miniature horses, however, are tame. They have been used as pets for hundreds of years. They listen to commands. Both dogs and miniature horses are trained to guide the blind. These animals can be trusted by pet owners and business owners.

Some people prefer to use service animals other than dogs and miniature horses and this is still possible. The new rules limit only the kind of service animals permitted in public places. In private, people are able to choose other animals. Some people with disabilities use monkeys to help them do tasks in their homes. These monkeys have similar hand and finger control to humans, so they can perform more tasks than other animals.

Would you like to learn more about the federal rules for service animals? You can visit the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) website. It gives details and reasons for changes in the rules.

Sources Used

Manning, S. (2011, April 11). Changing definitions new federal law limits service animals to dogs and mini-horses. Evansville Courier & Press. Retrieved from: http://www.courierpress.com/news/2011/apr/11/no-headline--11b05petsservice

U.S. Department of Justice. (2011, July 12). Service animals. Retrieved from: http://www.ada.gov/service_animals_2010.htm

#13 - 182646

Click on the boxes to match each source with the idea or ideas that it supports. Some ideas may have more than one source selected.

	Source #1: Monkey Helpers	**Source #2: Animals Helping People**	**Source #3: New Service Animal Rules**
People who own businesses have to consider the well-being of all of their guests.			
Being smart and able to handle small objects makes certain animals more appropriate than other animals to assist people who have a disability.			

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#14 - 182648

Which source would **most likely** be the most helpful in understanding how a service animal is trained? Explain why this source is **most likely** the most helpful. Give at least **two** details from the source to support your answer.

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Student Directions

Service Animals Opinion Performance Task

Part 2
You will now review your notes and sources, and plan, draft, revise, and edit your writing. You may use your notes and go back to the sources. Now read your assignment and the information about how your writing will be scored; then begin your work.

Your Assignment:
When your class returns from the library, your classmates begin to share what they learned about different types of service animals. They also begin to discuss the new rule that allows only dogs and miniature horses as service animals in public places. Some students agree with the rule, and some students disagree with the rule. Your teacher asks you to write a paper explaining your opinion about the new rule.

In your paper, you will take a side as to whether you agree with the rule allowing only service dogs and miniature horses in public places, or whether you disagree with the rule. Your paper will be read by your teacher and your classmates. Make sure you clearly state your opinion and write several paragraphs supporting your opinion with reasons and details from the sources. Develop your ideas clearly and use your own words, except when quoting directly from the sources. Be sure to give the source title or number for the details or facts you use.

REMEMBER: A well-written opinion paper

- has a clear opinion.
- is well-organized and stays on the topic.
- has an introduction and conclusion.
- uses transitions.
- uses details or facts from the sources to support your opinion.
- puts the information from the sources in your own words, except when using direct quotations from the sources.
- gives the title or number of the source for the details or facts you included.
- develops ideas clearly.
- uses clear language.
- follows rules of writing (spelling, punctuation, and grammar usage).

Now begin work on your opinion paper. Manage your time carefully so that you can

1. plan your opinion paper.
2. write your opinion paper.

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3. revise and edit the final draft of your opinion paper.

Word-processing tools and spell check are available to you.

For Part 2, you are being asked to write an opinion paper that is several paragraphs long. Type your response in the box below. The box will get bigger as you type.

Remember to check your notes and your prewriting/planning as you write and then revise and edit your opinion paper.

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#16 - 183047

A student is writing a research report about mountains. Read the sentences from his report and the directions that follow.

Mountains are areas of land that are taller than all of the land around them. Mountains can be found on every continent. Mountains come in different heights and shapes. Some are even so tall that trees cannot grow at the top of them. Some mountains are made of rocks and dirt and sand. Other mountains are made partly of lava from a volcano.

Choose **two** of the sources that would **most likely** give the student more information about the ideas he has written.

A. a website that shows people how to prepare to hike in the mountains

B. a poster showing a team of people climbing up the side of a steep mountain

C. an article from a book that describes how scientists think mountains were made

D. an online encyclopedia article describing different mountain ranges and types of mountains

E. a book telling the story of a young woman's desire to climb the largest mountain in the world

F. a book describing different types of volcanoes that are found around the world

#17 - 3057

A student is writing a research report about puffins. Click on **two** sentences that have information that the student can use in a paragraph about what puffins look like.

There are four different types of puffins: Atlantic Puffins, Horned Puffins, Tufted Puffins, and Rhinoceros Auklets. All puffins have some things in common: how they move, what they eat, and how they care for their young. The birds' black backs and white stomachs help them blend in with the color of the sky and the ocean. Puffins fly at very fast speeds. Puffins also swim well because they have webbed feet to paddle in the water. They eat fish from the ocean and sometimes catch ten fish at one time. Baby puffins are fed many times a day by their parents.

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